

Asortymentna Kimnata

Laboratory and Artist Residency Programme "Working Room" in Ukraine

APPEAL

Request for Support

Alona Karavai together with the Kyiv artist and curator Lesya Khomenko launches the art laboratory "Working Room". Please join and support this initiative.

To date, artists

Sasha Kurmaz, Kateryna Aleinik, Taira Umarova, Yaroslava Khomenko,
Nikita Kadan, Yvegen Arlov, Eugene Samborsky, Yarema Malashyuk,
Olia Yeremieieva, Leo Trotsenko, Olexander Surovtsov, Daniil Galkin, Zhanna
Kadyrova, Denis Ruban, Oleksiy Sai, Kateryna Buchatska, Mykola Ridnyi.
have joined the laboratory. More artists will join once they can reach.

The idea of the initiative is to create a quick format of residency and working laboratory for displaced artists on the basis of the Asortymentna Kimnata.
A workspace for experimentation and a vital and vibrant centre for visual culture.

"Working Room" is initiated by Alona Karavai, experienced in organisational development, in collaboration with artists. "Working Room" will provide displaced artists and artists which lost their studios and artworks, since the war started, working spaces and artist materials to resume actively creating.

It is our quest to save our country's artist legacy and building on the past, to create a new contemporary legacy. We work and create against oblivion and that our ideas and visions continue to live. We create for the current history of our country. Although we hope for peace but cannot predict what will be saved of our cultural heritage, it is our endeavour that testimony of the current artistic creation of Ukraine can continue to be produced and saved for future generations and mankind.

Given the dramatic current situation, topics that artists work with are related to Russia's war against Ukraine. The group of artists is working on a number of questions and topics, such as example:

What is our perception if the human body is changing?

How does dehumanization work in the context of war?

Is it possible to talk about self-dehumanization or a reflection of propaganda dehumanization?

What could be the results of ecological aspects of war as a gesture of aggression, not only of one human towards another one, but also its influence on inhuman behaviour of actors.

How are memory projects used to justify this war and how are certain events / dates rewritten?

Another goal of the artist residency is to create new material objects that can testify here, now and in a wider global context. It is important for us to work in Ukraine and, being inside the country, trying to reflect on our artistic practice and consider different artistic strategies. One of the most visible approaches in the art of rapid response is to show the image of the victim or the image of the winner.

In this context, we think of alternative approaches, which include the actual role of art and the artist as a figure.

"In a time of physical destruction, we will physically create. Culture and art are important at all times, I have already tested this during the 'Revolution of Dignity'. This is not a matter of necessity, it has nothing to do with survival, but it is very important at the diplomatic and geopolitical levels" said Lesia Khomenko.

The laboratory is implemented with the support of generous and forward thinking donors, private individuals from abroad -- colleagues and friends of artist Lesia Khomenko, and with the support of the

"Be Strong" project supported by the European Commission, The Halloran Foundation, the Kyiv Biennale, the NKN (Network of Artist Residency places in Northern Germany), The Oskar Schlemmer Theater Archives.

Organizationally, the laboratory is supported by the Asortymentna Kimnata, a non-profit organization, and the production of individual works of art, which will take place at the Frankivsk Drama Theater and Metalab.

The laboratory is currently being scaled up to a rural dimension -- a group of artists will be sheltered during at least one month (starting in April 2022) in the artist residency house [Khata-Maysternya](#) in the Carpathian Mountains, in the region of Ivano-Frankivsk.

The artist collective is preparing an exhibition representing works which were created in the residency and reflect the current situation of war. The exhibition will be premiered in the City History Museum in Ivano-Frankivsk in June. Subsequently it will travel until October and be exhibited Kyiv, Berlin, Essen and Vienna and hopefully other places in Europe. The "Working Room" exhibition tour, will be an important manifestation of a continuous cultural dialogue between Ukrainian and European art communities and showing the world that we create and resist.

For the implementation of the artist residency programme "Working Room" we desperately require additional funding for:

Creating makeshift studio spaces at the Artist Residence Khata-Maysternya,
Artist materials,

Documenting, photographing and publicising the artworks,

Store artworks and save artworks from besieged cities and regions,

The "exhibition tour" within the Ukraine and institutions in Europe.

A selection of artworks created exclusively during the artist residency programme will be published on a webpage, to be created.

All contributors, supporters and donors will receive:

Receipts for their donations and contributions by Asortymentna Kimnata,

Updates on the ongoing work at the artist residency programme, engaging you with the work, projects and ideas in progress,

Images of the artist residency and selected artworks being created at the laboratory "Working Room" at the Artist Residence Khata-Maysternya.

Once the situation will permit, we will plan to organise for interested donors, studio exhibition visits in Ukraine.

Major donors and supporting foundations will receive special complimentary awards from the participating artists.

Your gifts will enable artists displaced due the current war in Ukraine to continue working and to continue our mission to create new art and new ideas. Thank you for your generosity.

We invite you to become a patron of artists in Ukraine, the Artist Residence Khata-Maysternya and Asortymentna Kimnata.

Please understand and respect that we have crafted this text and programme under precarious living conditions during an ongoing war in Europe.

Please do not hesitate to contact us for further information, at:

Alona Karavai <karavai@insha-osvita.org>

Anna Potiomkina <Potiomkina@insha-osvita.org>

You may support our efforts and this project by donating any amount to the account of NGO Asortymentna Kimnata. Any gift will help.

Donation for artist residency programme of Asortymentna Kimnata in EUR:

Non-government organization "ASORTYMENTNA KIMNATA" (Ukraine)

Bank Name: JSC CB "PRIVATBANK"

Bank address: 1D HRUSHEVSKOHO STR., KYIV, 01001, UKRAINE

IBAN: UA373366770000026004052552815

SWIFT code/BIC: PBANUA2X

Legal address: UA 76018 Ivano-Frankivsk, Melnyka 10 str. 106 app.

Correspondent Banks

Commerzbank AG, Frankfurt am Main, Germany

Account in the correspondent bank : 400886700401, BIC COBADEFF
and

J.P. MORGAN AG, Frankfurt Am Main, Germany

Account in the correspondent bank : 6231605145, BIC CHASDEFX

Details of payment : **Working Room**

Charity donation for Artists Residency Program in Ukraine

Or you may pay on the personal PayPal of Anna Potyomkina

annapotyomkina@yahoo.com

Anna Potyomkina is curator of Asortymentna Kimnata.

Donors can choose name recognition in our future communications or their gift to remain anonymous. Please inform us of your preference.

We thank you for your support and solidarity.

"Asortymentna kimnata" (<https://www.facebook.com/asortymentna.kimnata>,
https://www.instagram.com/asortymentna_kimnata/)

For further reading and listening we recommend

[PUBLIC TALKS: NIKITA KADAN IN CONVERSATION WITH DAVID VELASCO](#)

27 April 2022 • Kyiv-based artist Nikita Kadan speaks about his project for *Artforum* at the opening days of the Venice Biennale 2022, Video

Nikita Kadan in: La Stampa, 21. April 2022 „Questa battaglia non sta ferma“, Audio
https://www.lastampa.it/audio/audioarticoli/2022/04/21/audio/nikita-kadan-e-gli-amabili_risti-di-kirov-questa-battaglia-non-sta-ferma-3149625/

Selected in German:

https://www.rbb-online.de/rbbkultur/radio/programm/schema/sendungen/der_tag/archiv/20220329_1600/kultur_aktuell_1610.html

<https://www.deutschlandfunkkultur.de/krieg-in-der-ukraine-koennen-kulturgueter-gerettet-werden-dlf-kultur-53c66055-100.html>

<https://www.br.de/kultur/interview-alona-karavai-krieg-schutz-evakuierung-ukraine-kunst-kultur-100.html>

<https://www.mumok.at/de/ausstellung/nikita-kadan>

FAZ <https://zeitung.faz.net/faz/feuilleton/2022-04-06/d5d9c0eb58f7fb847d0cdb734f6c2d76?GEPC=s5>

